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ST. DOMINIC SAVIO HIGH SCHOOL

BACKGROUNDGUIDE | UNDP

LETTERS TO DELEGATES
FROM THE CHAIR

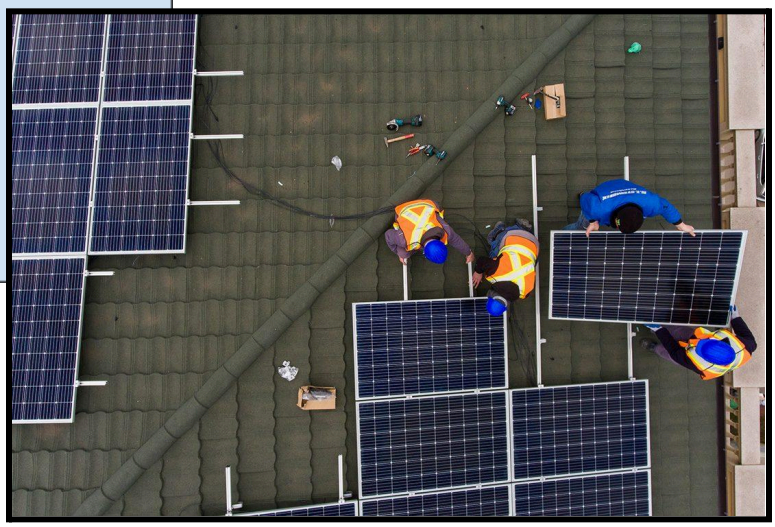
Dear Delegates,

Welcome to the United Nations Development Programme! My name is [Your Name], and I am honored to be your chair.

In this committee, we focus on helping countries grow in a way that is fair and good for the planet. Today, we are talking about energy. Think about your day: you use energy to turn on the lights, charge a phone or cook breakfast. But did you know that millions of people around the world still live without electricity?

Our goal is to figure out how we can give everyone access to clean energy like solar and wind, so they can go to school, stay healthy, and build businesses without hurting the environment. I look forward to hearing your ideas!

Image of Chair



Best wishes,

[Your Name,] Chair

INTRODUCTION

The UNDP works in 170 countries to help end poverty and protect the Earth. One of our biggest goals is Sustainable Development Goal 7 (SDG 7), which aims to provide affordable, reliable, and modern energy for all by the year 2030.

Renewable energy comes from natural sources that never run out, like the sun, wind, and water. By helping communities use these instead of coal or oil, we help them grow without causing more pollution.

TOPIC:

Promoting Sustainable Development through Renewable Energy Access

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

Currently, about 666 million people in the world do not have any electricity at all.

- Health: Without electricity, doctors can’t keep vaccines cold or use medical machines at night.
- Education: Students can’t study after the sun goes down because they don’t have lights.
- Pollution: Many families use wood or coal to cook inside their homes. The smoke from these fires is very dangerous to breathe, especially for children.

The problem is that building power lines to far away villages is very expensive. Renewable energy like a small solar panel on a roof is often the fastest and cheapest way to help these communities.

HISTORY OF THE PROBLEM

For a long time, the world relied on fossil fuels (like coal and oil) because they were cheap. However, these fuels cause global warming and are running out.

- 2015: The UN created the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Goal 7 was specifically about making energy clean and available to everyone.
- Today: The cost of solar panels and wind turbines has dropped by a lot, making it easier for poorer countries to start using them.

CURRENT SITUATION

The UNDP is currently working on an Energy Moonshot to help 500 million more people get access to clean energy by 2025.

- Solar for Health: In countries like Benin and India, the UNDP is installing solar panels on health centers so they never lose power during an emergency.
- Mini-Grids: In Africa, the UNDP is helping 21 countries build mini-grids. These are small power plants that use solar energy to power a whole village without needing to connect to a big city.

QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

- How can your country help build solar panels or wind turbines in rural areas that don’t have power?
- What can we do to help families switch from dangerous wood burning stoves to clean electric cooking?
- How can we train local people to fix and maintain solar panels so they last a long time?
- Where will the money come from to pay for these new energy projects?

LIST OF COUNTRIES (DELEGATION)

The Americas:
United States
Brazil
Mexico
Paraguay
Canada

Africa:
Nigeria
Ethiopia
Kenya
South Africa
Egypt
Benin

Oceania and Island Nations:
Philippines
Maldives
Fiji
Australia

Europe:
Germany
Norway
United Kingdom
France
Greece

Asia and the Middle East:
China
India
Indonesia
Saudi Arabia
Japan

KEY TERMS

- Renewable Energy: Energy from sources that replenish themselves, like sunlight, wind, and flowing water.
- SDG 7: The UN goal to ensure everyone has access to affordable and clean energy by 2030
- Mini-Grid: A small scale electricity system that provides power to a specific community, independent of the main national grid.
- Sustainable Development: Growing and improving our lives today without ruining the world for future generations.
- Energy Access: Having a reliable and safe source of electricity and clean cooking tools.

WORK CITED &

RESEARCH FOR STUDENTS:

- UNDP Energy Hub: https://www.undp.org/energy (Information on UNDP's global energy projects).
- UNICEF Data - SDG 7: https://data.unicef.org/sdgs/goal-7affordable-clean-energy/ (How energy affects children's health and schools)
- NASA Climate Kids: https://climatekids.nasa.gov/ (Easy to understand science on renewable energy).
- Sustainable Energy for All (SEforALL): https://www.seforall.org/ (Tracking global progress on energy access)